



TOOLBOX TALK — WEEKLY SAFETY MEETING

Millwork | Carpentry | Interior Finishes | Material Handling

WEEK 44

Date: Supervisor:

Project / Job Name:

TOPIC: Window & Door Trim (Casing) Installation

OVERVIEW:

Casing installation around doors and windows is one of the most detail-oriented tasks in finish carpentry. It combines miter saw cuts, pneumatic nailer work, and close work near finished surfaces at every step. The combination of frequent miter saw use and nailer work in tight spaces creates

TALKING POINTS — Read to Crew:

1. Casing installation involves a high volume of miter saw cuts — inside miters, outside miters, and square cuts for head casing and backbands. Volume creates complacency. As the day goes on and cuts become repetitive, operators begin making cuts faster, with less attention to setup, and with hands closer to the blade than early in the day. Build a deliberate reset habit into your miter saw
2. The nail path through casing must be planned before firing. Casing is typically 3/4 inch thick or less, and fasteners driven at the wrong angle can exit through the face of the trim, through the drywall, or into the jamb in the wrong location, splitting the wood. Use the nailer manufacturer's recommended fastener length for the material thickness, and test-drive one nail before committing
3. Do not nail within 1 inch of the end of any casing piece. End grain near the tip of a miter has very little material holding it together. A nail too close to the end will split the miter tip, requiring replacement of the entire casing piece. Pre-drill within 1 inch of ends if a fastener is absolutely required in that location, and even then, use a brad nailer rather than a finish nailer
4. Quality inspection before nailing saves time overall. Once casing is nailed in place, removing it for a quality problem damages the wall, the jamb, and often the casing piece itself. Before driving a single nail into any piece of casing, confirm the reveal is correct, the miter joints are tight, the piece is plumb and level, and the face is flush with adjacent surfaces. Two minutes of

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS — Ask Your Crew:

- Q1: What is the correct reveal measurement for casing installation on this project, and how do we verify it?
Q2: Walk through your miter saw safety check routine — what do you confirm before every cut?

KEY SAFETY POINTS:

- Check all cuts before nailing — measure twice, cut once
- Keep your body out of line with the nailer nose during all firing
- Do not nail within 1 inch of trim ends — splitting and nail pops will result
- Set nailer depth correctly — over-driven fasteners damage finished surfaces
- Inspect each piece for defects before cutting — knots cause dangerous blade catches

Crew sign-in sheet on page 2 — all 30 crew members sign on the following page.



CREW SIGN-IN SHEET

WEEK 44

By signing, I confirm I attended this toolbox talk and understand the topic discussed.

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